

Child Nutrition Guide

Good nutrition in the first years of life supports growth, immunity, and later eating habits. This guide covers exclusive milk feeding, complementary foods, and everyday family meals.

Exclusive breastfeeding is recommended for about the first six months when it is possible and wanted. Infant formula is an appropriate alternative when breastfeeding is not used. Cow's milk is not a main drink before twelve months.

Complementary foods are usually introduced at around six months, when the infant can sit with support and shows interest in food. Start with soft mashed vegetables, fruit, and iron-rich foods such as meat, beans, or fortified cereal.

Offer a variety of tastes and textures. There is no need to add salt or sugar. Honey should not be given to children under twelve months because of the risk of infant botulism.

Older children do well on regular meals and snacks built from vegetables, fruit, whole grains, protein foods, and dairy or fortified alternatives. Sweet drinks are best kept for occasional use.

This document does not discuss treatment of feeding disorders, allergies beyond a brief mention, or medication. Speak to a clinician if a child is losing weight, refusing all fluids, or has a suspected food allergy.